

RE: 22nd Ave S

From: "Burgesser, David" <david.burgesser@seattle.gov>
To: [REDACTED], "Spotts, Greg" <greg.spotts@seattle.gov>, "Chow, Evelyn" <evelyn.chow@seattle.gov>, "Colling, Sara" <sara.colling@seattle.gov>, "Hennessey, Bob" <bob.hennessey@seattle.gov>, "Harrison, Lisa M" <lisa.m.harrison@seattle.gov>
Cc: "Morales, Tammy" <tammy.morales@seattle.gov>, "Silvernail, Devin" <devin.silvernail@seattle.gov>, [REDACTED]
Date: Wed, 20 Sep 2023 13:56:02 -0700

Hi [REDACTED]

Thank you for following up with us on the pedestrian projects in this area. It was great to meet with [REDACTED] and you a few weeks ago to see these streets firsthand and better understand the context in this area.

I'll try to respond to each of your questions here, but please feel free to let us know if you have any additional follow up questions.

We would still like to know (a) where that money went, (b) why it didn't go to the budgeted uses, (c) the legal basis for not following the budget allocation, (d) what barriers remain to getting that sidewalk built, and (e) what steps we can take to overcome those barriers.

The [Council Budget Action that appropriated funds](#) to the sidewalk work identified four projects that would be eligible to receive these funds:

1. 22nd Ave S between S College St and S Bayview St
2. S Othello St between Military Rd S and Beacon Ave S
3. Streets adjacent to Rainier View Elementary School
4. Other locations in District 2

Our team has completed the project on S Othello St, will be delivering new walkways in the Rainier View area next year as part of [the neighborhood's Home Zone](#), and we have five other sidewalk projects planned in District 2 through the end of next year. This includes the walkway project we're planning on 21st Ave S between S Bayview St and S Walker St.

We did plan to move forward with the sidewalk project on 22nd Ave S and completed an early-phase design of the project. However, due to the technical site constraints (steep driveways, steep grades at the edge of the roadway, drainage challenges), it would cost at least \$1.5M to complete this project alone, which would have prevented us from delivering other projects in the budget action and is beyond what the program has funding to complete in the next two years. We still recognize the importance of this project and hope to complete this in the future when funding becomes available, but we are prioritizing the walkway on 21st Ave S as a near-term project to ensure there's still a safe and comfortable walking route provided that serves the Giddens School and Lake Washington Girls Middle School from the south.

The block of 21st Ave S between College and Walker is absolutely not safe for pedestrians without installing a sidewalk--not bendy bollards frustrating residents who want to park